

Ban! What Ban?

34 outfits are on the banned list. But it is business as usual for them.

- **United Liberation Front of Assam:** To establish a sovereign Assam. Banned in 1990.
- **National Democratic Front of Bodoland:** Securing a sovereign Bodoland. Banned in 1993.
- **National Liberation Front of Tripura:** Independent Tripuri state. Banned in 1993.
- **Babbar Khalsa International:** Formation of Khalistan. Banned in 1992.
- **Khalistan Commando Force:** Establishing Khalistan. Banned in 1992.
- **Lashkar-e-Toiba:** Independence of J&K. Involved in Parliament attack, Mumbai train blasts and 26/11 Mumbai terror attacks. Banned in 2000.
- **Jaish-e-Mohammad:** J&K independence. Banned in 2000.
- **Harkat-ul-Mujahideen:** J&K independence. Banned in 2000.
- **Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam:** Creation of independent Tamil state in north and east Sri Lanka, accused of assassinating Rajiv Gandhi. Banned in 1992.
- **Students Islamic Movement of India:** Providing support to militant outfits like LeT and HuM. Banned in 2001.
- **Deendar-e-Anjuman:** Originated in Karnataka, responsible for serial church blasts. Banned in 2001.
- **Al-Qaida:** Radical Islamic movement to establish true Islamic states. Banned in 2002.
- **Dukhtaran-e-Millat:** J&K women's secessionist group, helping in hawala funding of terror organisations. Banned in 2002.

keep tabs on underground outfits, it would still make sense in banning them. However, activities of SIMI became more virulent and violent after the ban, with its involvement alleged in several terror acts including the 2006 Mumbai train bombings and 2008 serial blasts in Jaipur, Ahmedabad and Delhi. The organisation was providing logistical support to Pakistan-based jihadi outfits.

To circumvent the ban, security agencies believe that SIMI was now operating as Indian Mujahideen, and there were fears that the outfit had been penetrated by the Al-Qaida, another proscribed organisation. Changing of names had become a common practice for many of the banned groups to continue business as usual. The LET had changed its

to establish that it is the same group, which sometimes becomes difficult."

The official who was involved in the decision-making process of banning the Maoists, said that proscription was helpful since it empowered the security agencies to not only take swift action against the group and its members but also in expediting prosecution and trial. "The ban definitely puts pressure on the organisation. No overground activity is permitted. Intelligence and security agencies keep an enhanced watch on the group, especially on sources of funding," he said. In fact, Maoist leader Koteswar Rao, who was heading guerrilla operations in Lalgarh, is already believed to have left the area and disappeared. Tribals, who were supporting him,

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SRI LANKA HAS SHOWN THAT POLITICAL WILL BACKED BY ACTION CAN MAKE A BAN WORK.

RELIABLE INTELLIGENCE INPUTS AND DETERMINATION HELPED COLOMBO NAIL PRABHAKARAN

name to Pasban-e-Ahle Hadis. When Jamaat-ud-Dawa was accused of working as LET's front outfit in the wake of 26/11, and banned by the UN, it is believed to have changed its name to Falah-e-Insaniyat. The JEM had become Tehrik-e-Furqan. The Harkat-ul-Mujahideen had changed names to Harkat-ul-Ansar and then to Karkat-ul-Jehad-e-Islami.

For the ban to be effective, the Government needs to update the list and keep adding the new names to it. Admits a Home Ministry official, "It's easier to prosecute if the new name is listed or else the investigators have

are backing off and the Maoists are now saying that they are willing to come to the negotiating table for talks with the Centre and the state.

Senior Home Ministry officials feel the ban was necessary as there were intelligence inputs that the Maoists may indulge in violence by targeting security forces and economic infrastructure such as trains, buses, railway and bus stations. If indeed it were so, Prakash Karat's opinion that the ultras be isolated and weaned away from violence is one that nobody occupying high office can afford to hold.